never heard.

It was an anthology of particular interest to me in that it con-

tained a story of mine, "Blind Alley/' This was the first of my stories ever to be anthologized.

On February 25, I found a letter from Campbell, enclosing a check for $42.50 as payment for the use of the story in that anthology. The payment was actually made to Astounding, which owned all rights to the story. There was no legal requirement that Astounding pass on any part of that check to the author. Campbell, however, insisted that every penny be passed on to the authors, and he had his way. 9

It was the first indication I ever had that a story could make any money in addition to the initial payment from the magazine. It was also the first bit of money from my writing that I had made while I was in the Army.

*7

Meanwhile I actually went to a USO dance in Richmond on the night of February 9, 1946.

I danced with a very pretty girl and made a date with her for the next day. I stayed in Richmond overnight and then had the date with her. I know exactly what I had in mind and I might have carried it through. I think she was willing.

But I couldn't! After I got to her place and after I'd been there a while and made some tentative advances, I suddenly said I had to go back to camp. She looked shocked and let me go.

I did go straight back to camp rather hang-dog and ashamed of myself for humiliating the girl and humiliating myself—but I couldn't help it. I hadn't gone to bed with anyone but Gertrude in my whole life, and the thought of doing so was unbearable. (I went through my entire Army career without any extramarital ventures.)

As it turned out, my attack of fidelity turned out to be a lucky break. No sooner had I reached camp than the weather turned very bad. Had I stayed in Richmond for most of the tenth and then tried to get back to camp overnight, I would have been unable to make it by roll call on the morning of the eleventh, and I would have been AWOL. What would have followed, I don't know.